

Refund & Cancellation Policy — Reference Notes (for RAG / FAQ agent)

Summarized in plain language from publicly available Indian Railways passenger reservation rules, for use as static FAQ knowledge in this project. Not an official document — verify exact current rules on the official IRCTC site before relying on this for real bookings.

Cancellation charges (Confirmed tickets)

- More than 48 hours before scheduled departure: a flat minimum cancellation charge per class (varies by class, e.g. AC First, AC 2-Tier, AC 3-Tier/AC Chair Car, Sleeper) is deducted.
- Between 48 hours and 12 hours before departure: 25% of the fare (subject to minimum flat charge) is deducted.
- Between 12 hours and 4 hours before departure: 50% of the fare (subject to minimum flat charge) is deducted.
- Less than 4 hours before departure: generally no refund, except under specific circumstances (train cancelled by Railways, etc.).

Waitlisted (WL) tickets

- If a WL ticket does not get confirmed and the passenger does not travel, full refund (minus a small clerkage charge) is generally given, provided cancellation is done before chart preparation.
- WL tickets booked online are auto-cancelled if not confirmed by chart preparation, and refunded automatically.

RAC tickets

- Cancellation charges for RAC tickets are lower than confirmed tickets but higher than pure waitlist, and follow a similar time-based slab structure.

Tatkal tickets

- Tatkal confirmed tickets are generally not refundable except in case of train cancellation, or category-specific exceptions.

Train cancelled / rescheduled by Railways

- Full refund is provided regardless of cancellation timing, since the cancellation isn't at the passenger's initiative.

How to request a refund

1. For online (IRCTC) bookings, cancellation and refund can be initiated directly through the IRCTC account.
2. For counter bookings, a TDR (Ticket Deposit Receipt) may need to be filed at the station or online within the prescribed window.
3. Refunds are typically processed back to the original payment method within a few business days.

Notes for this project

This file is intentionally written as generic reference text (not copied from any single source) so it's safe to use as ground-truth for a RAG/FAQ agent tool, e.g. ``search_refund_policy(query)``.